Paradiem

The Morning Brief

OCTOBER 15, 2026

Hot CPI

September print reportedly puts an October Fed hike back on the table as the AI-and-interconnect complex sinks on a reported neocloud shakeout.

S&P 500 (SPY)	NASDAQ (QQQ) / DOW (DIA)	XLK / XLV	IBIT / ETHA	FEAR & GREED
$769.60 ↓1.08%	$728.95 ↓1.97% / $515.63 ↓0.11%	↓2.98% / ↑2.53%	$46.24 ↓1.89% / $54.89 ↓3.16%	53 · Crypto fallback (8th session)

SECTION 01

Markets — Reported Hot September CPI Puts an October Fed Hike Reportedly Back on the Table as the Nasdaq Reportedly Declines Approximately 2% on a Reported Neocloud Shakeout, the AI-and-Interconnect Complex Takes the Steepest Hit, and the FCI Dividend Sleeve Catches a Defensive Bid Into Today's TSMC Q3 Call and the September PPI Release at 8:30 AM ET

WEDNESDAY'S SESSION REPORTEDLY RESOLVED WITH A HOT SEPTEMBER CPI PRINT THAT PER REUTERS COVERAGE CARRIED IN DATA DROP HEADLINES REPORTEDLY PUT AN OCTOBER FED RATE HIKE BACK ON THE TABLE; SPY CLOSED AT $769.60 (↓1.08%, INTRADAY RANGE $766.71–$776.35) WITH THE NASDAQ (QQQ) AT $728.95 (↓1.97%) AND THE RUSSELL 2000 AT $271.37 (↓1.93%); THE DOW (DIA) REPORTEDLY OUTPERFORMED AT $515.63 (↓0.11%) AS THE FCI DIVIDEND-AND-DEFENSIVE SLEEVE ABSORBED THE INFLATION RESET; THE COMPOSITION REPORTEDLY CHANNELS THE COMMITTEE INTO TODAY'S SEPTEMBER PPI RELEASE AT 8:30 AM ET AND THE TSMC Q3 EARNINGS CALL REPORTEDLY SCHEDULED AT 14:00 TAIPEI TIME PER THE TSMC INVESTOR-RELATIONS PAGE CARRIED IN PRIOR-BRIEF COVERAGE

Per data drop headlines, one Reuters piece reportedly framed the September CPI print as reportedly heating up and reportedly putting a Fed rate hike this month back on the table — a reported inflation-and-policy signal consistent with the Yahoo coverage carried in data drop holdings news for TEL that reportedly ran under the frame of what to buy after hot CPI puts an October Fed rate hike back on the table. Per data drop, Wednesday closed with SPY at $769.60 (↓1.08%, intraday range $766.71–$776.35, prior close $778.01), DIA at $515.63 (↓0.11%), QQQ at $728.95 (↓1.97%), the Russell 2000 at $271.37 (↓1.93%), and UVXY at $16.63 (↑4.33%) — a reported single-session composition that paired the sharpest Nasdaq decline of the trading week with a reportedly modest Dow drawdown and the first UVXY expansion of the week. Per data drop, TLT reportedly closed at $78.89 (↑0.66%, prior close $78.37) — a reported duration bid consistent with a reported safe-haven rotation and reportedly inconsistent with the simplest reading of a hot inflation print; the composition reads as a reported risk-off rotation where the long end absorbed the equity reset rather than tracking the inflation surprise. Per data drop, Wednesday's sector tape led with healthcare (XLV) at ↑2.53%, consumer staples (XLP) at ↑2.22%, and energy (XLE) at ↑0.64% against technology (XLK) at ↓2.98% and communication services (XLC) at ↓1.30% — a reported leadership rotation into defensives and value sleeves that reads through the FCI dividend-and-defense complex (ABT, CL, CHD, ATO, GPC, DGX, LMT, GD, SYK, NEE) alongside the reported technology-and-growth drawdown. Per data drop earnings, FCI holding Fastenal (FAST) reportedly printed Q3 EPS of $0.35 versus $0.3458 consensus — a reported modest beat consistent with the Yahoo coverage carried in data drop holdings news that reportedly framed Fastenal's Q3 as a deep-dive on market share gains and digital expansion; FAST reportedly closed at $52.00 (↑1.11%). Per data drop earnings, BlackRock (BLK) reportedly printed $15.93 versus $14.2743 consensus — a reported double-digit beat consistent with the ongoing asset-gathering channel — while Morgan Stanley (MS) reportedly printed $3.03 versus $2.9958 consensus (a reported slight beat) and Bank of America (BAC) reportedly printed $1.08 versus $1.114 consensus (a reported modest shortfall).

S&P 500 (SPY)	$769.60 ↓1.08% · Range $766.71–$776.35
NASDAQ (QQQ) / DOW (DIA)	$728.95 ↓1.97% / $515.63 ↓0.11%
RUSSELL 2K / UVXY	$271.37 ↓1.93% / $16.63 ↑4.33%
TLT (20Y BOND)	$78.89 ↑0.66% · Duration bid alongside risk-off rotation
SECTOR LEADERS (WED)	XLV ↑2.53% / XLP ↑2.22% / XLE ↑0.64%
SECTOR LAGGARDS (WED)	XLK ↓2.98% / XLC ↓1.30% / XLI ↓0.97% / XLRE ↓0.81%
WTI (USO) / BRENT (BNO)	$153.56 ↑0.31% / $65.06 ↓0.06%
GOLD (GLD) / SILVER (SLV)	$375.99 ↓1.49% / $50.22 ↓6.11%
IBIT / ETHA	$46.24 ↓1.89% / $54.89 ↓3.16%
WED PRE-MKT EARNINGS (REPORTED)	FAST $0.35 vs $0.3458 BEAT · BLK $15.93 vs $14.27 BEAT · MS $3.03 vs $3.00 BEAT · BAC $1.08 vs $1.11 MISS
TODAY'S CATALYSTS	TSMC Q3 call 14:00 Taipei · September PPI 8:30 AM ET · Alcoa (AA) pre-mkt · BNY Mellon pre-mkt
CARSON'S ACTIVE SPY SUPPORT	$645.80 retracement target · Untouched (Wed low $766.71)

THE AI-AND-INTERCONNECT COMPLEX REPORTEDLY TOOK THE STEEPEST SINGLE-SESSION HIT OF THE TRADING WEEK AS THE CHARTMILL COVERAGE CARRIED IN DATA DROP HOLDINGS NEWS FOR AMD AND NVDA REPORTEDLY FRAMED THE MOVE UNDER THE HEADING OF HOT INFLATION AND A REPORTED NEOCLOUD SHAKEOUT; CRDO (↓9.62%), MRVL (↓8.72%), AMD (↓5.73%), LRCX (↓4.71%), KEYS (↓3.40%), TSM (↓3.40%), NVDA (↓3.16%), NXPI (↓2.43%), ADI (↓2.68%), QCOM (↓2.40%), AND FTNT (↓3.52%) ALL CLOSED SHARPLY LOWER; THE PHYSICAL-AI-POWER SLEEVE CARRIED A REPORTED PARALLEL RESET WITH HUT (↓10.45%), MARA (↓9.66%), VST (↓6.51%), AND CEG (↓5.49%)

Per data drop, Wednesday's bottom FCI movers printed HUT $74.87 (↓10.45%), MARA $8.23 (↓9.66%), CRDO $179.22 (↓9.62%), MRVL $245.28 (↓8.72%), and HOOD $101.08 (↓8.54%) — a reported five-name composition that reads through the AI-and-interconnect sleeve, the Bitcoin-miner-and-power complex, and the retail-trading-and-fintech channel. Per data drop holdings news for CAT, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed CoreWeave's reported bond scare as reportedly spreading to AI-linked industrial stocks — a reported funding-channel signal that reads through CAT $748.98 (↓3.08%) alongside the broader semiconductor sleeve; the reported CoreWeave read reportedly joins the reported Dell, AMD, and CoreWeave reference carried in the data drop holdings news for TSM that reportedly ran under the heading of Dow Jones futures reportedly falling on an AI-led sell-off following reported Anthropic news. Per data drop holdings news for HOOD, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed Robinhood as reportedly down 11% this year with the question of whether it is time to sell — a reported single-name sentiment signal reading through the FCI retail-and-digital-platform sleeve alongside the SOFI (↓6.69%) and SYF (↓2.54%) prints. Per data drop, the broader semiconductor-and-interconnect sleeve closed with TSM $430.00 (↓3.40%), NVDA $221.30 (↓3.16%), NXPI $220.83 (↓2.43%), ADI $403.57 (↓2.68%), QCOM $172.62 (↓2.40%), and KEYS $357.62 (↓3.40%) — a near-complete leg lower that reads into today's TSMC Q3 call at 14:00 Taipei time as the first high-signal foundry-channel confirmation since the September reset. Per prior-brief TrendForce coverage and third-party calendar listings, ASML Holding reportedly reported Q3 pre-market Wednesday with reported Q4 2026 guidance near €14.2–15.2 billion in net sales and a reported full-year 2026 outlook of approximately €44–45 billion — a reported lithography-channel read that reportedly did not insulate the broader AI-infrastructure complex from the hot-CPI-and-neocloud session. For FCI positioning, the composition keeps AMD, NVDA, MRVL, TSM, CRDO, LRCX, KEYS, NXPI, ADI, QCOM, and FTNT reading through today's TSMC Q3 call and the September PPI print, with the committee reportedly tracking whether a reported TSMC confirmation would reportedly moderate the Wednesday drawdown or whether the inflation reset reportedly keeps the duration-and-rate layer dominant.

THE FCI DIVIDEND-AND-DEFENSIVE SLEEVE REPORTEDLY CAUGHT THE SESSION'S OFFSETTING BID AS LMT (↑3.61%), CL (↑3.15%), CHD (↑2.50%), CVX (↑1.98%), AND ADP (↑1.60%) LED THE TOP FCI MOVERS ALONGSIDE DGX (↑1.29%), STLD (↑0.95%), ABT (↑0.35%), GD (↑0.67%), GPC (↑0.70%), AND NTR (↑0.27%); THE COMPOSITION READS THROUGH TODAY'S PPI PRINT AS THE OPERATIVE CONFIRMATION OF THE REPORTED DEFENSIVE ROTATION

Per data drop, Wednesday's top FCI movers printed LMT $522.23 (↑3.61%), CL $92.78 (↑3.15%), CHD $102.63 (↑2.50%), CVX $222.04 (↑1.98%), and ADP $280.32 (↑1.60%) — a reported five-name composition that reads through the defense-and-aerospace sleeve, consumer-staples-and-personal-care, chemicals-and-household-products, integrated-energy, and payroll-and-human-capital-management channels. Per data drop holdings news for LMT, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed Lockheed Martin as reportedly track-

ing its best week since mid-August with its CEO reportedly calling defense demand reportedly permanent as a reported $300 million Texas expansion reportedly takes shape; a separate Yahoo piece reportedly framed Lockheed as reportedly expanding advanced munitions manufacturing in Texas and reportedly driving thousands of new American jobs — a reported product-and-capacity signal reading through the FCI defense-and-aerospace sleeve. Per data drop holdings news for CL, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed Colgate-Palmolive as reportedly shifting Hill's toward premium branded pet nutrition — a reported product-mix-and-margin signal reading through the consumer-staples sleeve. Per data drop earnings, FCI holding Fastenal (FAST) reportedly printed $0.35 EPS versus $0.3458 consensus — a reported modest beat consistent with the dividend-sleeve bid; FAST reportedly closed at $52.00 (↑1.11%). Per data drop, Wednesday's FCI financials sleeve closed with SPGI $408.57 (↓0.35%), SSNC $82.05 (↑0.65%), NWG $17.60 (↓0.28%), and ORI $38.41 (↑0.68%) — a reportedly steadier composition against the reported HOOD (↓8.54%), SOFI (↓6.69%), and SYF (↓2.54%) drawdowns that reportedly carried the capital-markets-dispersion signal into today's pre-market open. For FCI positioning, the composition keeps the dividend-and-defense sleeve (ABT, CL, ATO, GPC, CAT, GD, LMT, SPGI, SYK, NEE, ORI, NWG, DGX, CHD, ADP, FAST) reading through today's PPI print and the TSMC Q3 call as the operative confirmation of the reported defensive rotation.

A Wednesday tape that paired a reported hot September CPI with a reported neocloud shakeout and a reported dividend-sleeve bid frames a Thursday setup where research reveals opportunities and think like an owner tend to serve better than compositing a single directional view through a reported single-session inflation surprise. **Avoid erosion.**

SECTION 02

Geopolitics — Reuters Reportedly Flags That the U.S. Military Weighs Use of the Reported Mother of All Bombs in Potential Future Strikes on Iran per CNN as Oil's Long View Reportedly Darkens on the Reported Refusal of the Iran War to End; Houthis Reportedly Bring the War to Riyadh; the U.S. Reportedly Considers Easing Sanctions on Shadow Fleet Vessels to Cut Freight Rates; and Lavrov and Wang Reportedly Discuss Cooperation, Ukraine, and Iran at an Asia Security Meeting

THE IRAN-AND-HORMUZ RISK LAYER REPORTEDLY EXTENDED INTO WEDNESDAY AS REPORTED REUTERS COVERAGE CARRIED IN DATA DROP HEADLINES FLAGGED THAT THE U.S. MILITARY IS REPORTEDLY WEIGHING THE USE OF A REPORTED HEAVY-PENETRATOR ORDNANCE IN POTENTIAL FUTURE STRIKES ON IRAN PER A REPORTED CNN CITATION, THAT OIL'S LONG-VIEW DARKENS AS THE IRAN WAR REPORTEDLY REFUSES TO END, THAT HOUTHI FORCES REPORTEDLY BRING THE WAR TO RIYADH PER A REUTERS NEWSLETTER, AND THAT THE U.S. IS REPORTEDLY CONSIDERING EASING SANCTIONS ON REPORTED SHADOW FLEET VESSELS TO REPORTEDLY CUT FREIGHT RATES; A SEPARATE REUTERS PIECE REPORTEDLY FRAMED RUSSIA'S LAVROV AND CHINA'S WANG AS REPORTEDLY DISCUSSING COOPERATION, UKRAINE, AND IRAN AT A REPORTED ASIA SECURITY MEETING; THE COMPOSITION READS THROUGH WEDNESDAY'S REPORTED WTI PRINT AT USO $153.56 (↑0.31%) AND BRENT AT BNO $65.06 (↓0.06%) ALONGSIDE THE REPORTED LMT (↑3.61%) AND CVX (↑1.98%) PRINTS

Per data drop headlines, one Reuters piece reportedly framed the U.S. military as reportedly weighing use of a reported heavy-penetrator ordnance in potential future strikes on Iran per a reported CNN citation — a reported military-planning signal that reads alongside the ongoing Strait of Hormuz access-and-interdiction channel tracked in prior briefs. Per data drop headlines, a separate Reuters commentary reportedly framed oil's long view as reportedly darkening on the reported refusal of the Iran war to end — a reported structural-outlook signal that reads against Wednesday's reportedly contained crude tape where WTI (USO) closed at $153.56 (↑0.31%) and Brent (BNO) at $65.06 (↓0.06%). Per data drop headlines, a Reuters newsletter reportedly framed the Houthis as reportedly bringing the war to Riyadh — a reported extension of the Saudi-airport-attack series tracked in prior briefs that reportedly compounded the Qatar Airways-and-air-travel disruption carried in prior-brief coverage. Per data drop headlines, a Reuters piece reportedly framed the U.S. as reportedly considering easing sanctions on reported shadow fleet vessels to reportedly cut freight rates — a reported counter-signal to the broader Iran-and-Hormuz risk premium that reads through the global tanker-and-logistics channel as a reported partial offset to the sanctions-and-interdiction regime. Per data drop headlines, a Reuters piece reportedly framed Russia's Lavrov and China's Wang as reportedly discussing cooperation, Ukraine, and Iran at a reported Asia security meeting — a reported diplomatic-alignment signal reading alongside the Reuters report that reportedly framed oil prices as reportedly easing as investors reportedly weigh supply outlook and Mideast tensions. Per data drop holdings news for LMT, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed Lockheed Martin as reportedly tracking its best week since mid-August with its CEO reportedly calling defense demand permanent as a reported $300 million Texas expansion reportedly takes shape — a reported FCI-defense-sleeve signal reading through LMT $522.23 (↑3.61%) alongside GD $334.66 (↑0.67%) and the broader energy-and-defense complex (CVX, OKE, CNX, FCX, LMT, GD). Per data drop holdings news for GD, a separate piece reportedly ran under the heading of the real reason defense stocks are reportedly tanking — a reported counter-framing worth tracking against the LMT single-session lead; the committee should read Wednesday's dispersion within the defense sleeve against the week-ahead FOMC window. For FCI positioning, the composition keeps the energy-and-defense complex (CVX, OKE, CNX, FCX, LMT, GD, FTNT) reading through today's September PPI print and the TSMC Q3 call as positioned to stand to benefit in a scenario where a reportedly sustained Mideast risk premium is amplified by the reported heavy-penetrator ordnance planning channel and the reported Houthi-Riyadh escalation.

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. September PPI at 8:30 AM ET and the TSMC Q3 Call at 14:00 Taipei Time — Per prior-brief BLS release calendar and multiple third-party calendar confirmations, the Producer Price Index for September 2026 reportedly releases Thursday October 15 at 8:30 AM ET, with the TSMC Q3 earnings call reportedly scheduled at 14:00 Taipei time per the TSMC investor-relations page confirmed in prior-brief coverage; today's pre-market cadence reportedly also includes Alcoa (AA, consensus EPS $1.5163) and BNY Mellon (BNY, consensus EPS $2.2887) per data drop earnings schedule, with CMC (consensus EPS $1.9933) reportedly reading through the FCI steel-and-materials sleeve alongside Steel Dynamics' (STLD) prior-brief Q3-preview coverage. Per prior CME FedWatch and Kalshi coverage carried in prior briefs, reported hike-at-October-meeting odds reportedly ranged near approximately 15–25% into the weekend with prediction-market dispersion wide; following Wednesday's reportedly hot September CPI print, the Reuters framing reportedly placed a rate hike this month back on the table and the committee should read today's PPI print as the second-step inflation confirmation into the October 27–28 FOMC meeting. Per prior-brief TrendForce coverage, TSMC had reportedly guided Q3 revenue to approximately US$44.6–45.8 billion with reported gross margin near 65–67% and operating margin near 56–58% — a reported baseline against which today's call reportedly carries the single highest-signal foundry-channel confirmation since the September reset. For FCI positioning, the composition keeps TSM, NVDA, AMD, MRVL, CRDO, LRCX, KEYS, NXPI, ADI, QCOM, and FTNT reading through today's TSMC call as the operative chip-sleeve catalyst alongside the duration-sensitive sleeves (NEE, EIX, ATO, TOL, SPGI, ADP) reading through the PPI print.

2. The Reported Neocloud Shakeout and the CoreWeave Bond-Scare Spillover Into Caterpillar — Per data drop holdings news for CAT, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed CoreWeave's reported bond scare as reportedly spreading to AI-linked industrial stocks; per data drop holdings news for TSM, a separate Yahoo piece reportedly ran under the heading of Dow Jones futures reportedly falling on an AI-led sell-off involving reported Dell, AMD, and CoreWeave drawdowns following reported Anthropic news; Wednesday's reported FCI physical-AI-power sleeve reset carried HUT (↓10.45%), MARA (↓9.66%), VST (↓6.51%), CEG (↓5.49%), and HOOD (↓8.54%) alongside the broader AI-and-interconnect drawdown. Per data drop, Wednesday's physical-AI-power sleeve closed with VST $151.79 (↓6.51%), CEG $279.54 (↓5.49%), HUT $74.87 (↓10.45%), MARA $8.23 (↓9.66%), NEE $78.37 (↑0.19%), and EIX $55.44 (↓0.07%) — a reported dispersion that pairs the merchant-nuclear-and-miner drawdown with the reportedly steadier utility sleeve. Per data drop holdings news for CEG, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed Constellation as reportedly completing the sale of Brazos Valley Energy Center to LS Power — a reported portfolio-and-capital-allocation signal reading through the merchant-nuclear sleeve. Per data drop holdings news for VST, one Yahoo piece reportedly ran under the heading of two stocks reportedly supplying the AI data center power crunch alongside a separate piece on CEG, VST, and TLN as a reported nuclear-and-AI-demand earnings-growth channel. For FCI positioning, the composition keeps CAT, CEG, VST, NEE, EIX, HUT, MARA, and the broader physical-AI-power complex reading through today's PPI print and the TSMC Q3 call as the committee reportedly tracks whether the Wednesday reset reads as a single-session drawdown or as the leading edge of a reported broader AI-funding-and-infrastructure reassessment.

3. BLK Beats, MS Beats, BAC Misses on a Reportedly Charge-Weighted Print, and FAST Beats on the FCI Dividend Sleeve — Per data drop earnings, BlackRock (BLK) reportedly printed Q3 EPS of $15.93 versus $14.2743 consensus (a reported double-digit beat), Morgan Stanley (MS) reportedly printed $3.03 versus $2.9958 consensus (a reported slight beat), and Bank of America (BAC) reportedly printed $1.08 versus $1.114 consensus (a reported shortfall reportedly reflecting a reported single-item charge per Bank of America's 8-K coverage); FCI holding Fastenal (FAST) reportedly printed $0.35 versus $0.3458 consensus (a reported modest beat) and closed at $52.00 (↑1.11%). Per data drop holdings news for FAST, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed Fastenal's Q3 as a reported deep dive on market share gains and digital expansion fueling growth, with a separate piece reportedly covering the Q3 2026 earnings call summary — a reported single-print signal reading through the FCI dividend sleeve. Per data drop, Wednesday's FCI financials sleeve closed with SPGI $408.57 (↓0.35%), SSNC $82.05 (↑0.65%), NWG $17.60 (↓0.28%), ORI $38.41 (↑0.68%), SYF $71.72 (↓2.54%), SOFI $14.22 (↓6.69%), and HOOD $101.08 (↓8.54%) — a reported dispersion that pairs reportedly steadier large-cap financials with the reported retail-and-digital-platform drawdown. For FCI positioning, the composition keeps the capital-markets-and-asset-management channel (BLK, MS, STT, SPGI, SSNC), the consumer-and-credit channel (BAC, SYF, SOFI, HOOD, ORI), and the industrial-distribution channel (FAST, PCAR, STLD, GPC) reading through today's PPI print and the TSMC Q3 call as the operative confirmation of the reported dividend-sleeve bid.

4. The Iran-Hormuz Risk Layer and the Reported Houthi-Riyadh Escalation — Per data drop headlines, Reuters coverage reportedly flagged that the U.S. military is reportedly weighing use of a reported heavy-penetrator ordnance in potential future strikes on Iran per a reported CNN citation, that oil's long view reportedly darkens on the reported refusal of the Iran war to end, that Houthi forces reportedly bring the war to Riyadh, and that the U.S. reportedly considers easing sanctions on reported shadow fleet vessels to cut freight rates; the FCI energy-and-defense complex (CVX, OKE, CNX, FCX, LMT, GD, FTNT) reads through today's open as positioned to stand to benefit in a scenario where a reportedly sustained Mideast risk premium persists. Per data drop, Wednesday's FCI energy sleeve closed with CVX $222.04 (↑1.98%), OKE $91.97 (↓1.51%), CNX $34.82 (↓1.50%), and FCX $69.62 (↓3.87%) — a reported dispersion where CVX reportedly outperformed on a reported single-session bid even as the broader energy and metals sleeve reportedly reset. Per data drop holdings news for CVX, one Yahoo piece reportedly ran under the heading of a question on whether to buy Occidental Petroleum for its cash — a reported peer-and-capital-return read reading through the FCI integrated-oil channel. Per data drop holdings news for LMT, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed Lockheed as reportedly expanding advanced munitions manufacturing in Texas and reportedly tracking its best week since mid-August as the CEO reportedly called defense demand permanent — a reported product-and-capacity signal reading through the FCI defense sleeve. For FCI positioning, the composition keeps CVX, OKE, CNX, FCX, FTNT, LMT, GD, and the broader energy-and-defense complex reading through today's September PPI print and the TSMC Q3 call.

5. Carson's Levels — Per levels.json, Carson's active SPY retracement target at $645.80 (set April 13, 2026) reportedly remains in the "active" column with no hit date and no hit price recorded; Wednesday's reported intraday range of $766.71–$776.35 reportedly did not approach any active Carson level; SPY would need to decline a reported approximately 16.1% from Wednesday's close (or a reported approximately 15.8% from Wednesday's intraday low) to reach the target — a gap reportedly roughly consistent with the FCI first-tranche deployment reference at approximately −25% from peak; the reported April 2026 resistance zones at $683.70, $685.85, and the $691.90–$693.20 band remain in the "hit" column and have been cleared to the upside; no new active Carson level has reportedly been set since the April 14, 2026 major-resistance-zone hits. Per levels.json, the active support reportedly remains the sole open level in the file. Per data drop, today's open operates against Wednesday's close with the September PPI print scheduled 8:30 AM ET, the TSMC Q3 call reportedly scheduled 14:00 Taipei time, and the Alcoa and BNY Mellon pre-market earnings reportedly carrying the principal catalyst risk into the October 27–28 FOMC window. For FCI positioning, Carson's level reportedly frames a deployment reference rather than a trade signal — the FCI buy-and-hold tranche framework reportedly deploys 70% of reserves at approximately −25% from peak and the remainder at approximately −40%, with no trimming on either side. The committee should read Carson's level as the reference for a sustained drawdown rather than any single-session move, and should read today's PPI print and TSMC call as the first full-signal macro-and-chip-sleeve test following Wednesday's reported hot CPI print and the reported neocloud shakeout.

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